ECCLESIASTES

OR, THE PREACHER

The Preacher declares that All Things are Vanity. His own Experience of the Vanity of Knowledge and of Pleasure

1 The words of [1] the [a]Preacher, the son of David, [b]king in Jerusalem.

2 [c]Vanity of vanities, saith the [a]Preacher; vanity of vanities, all is vanity. 3 [d]What profit hath man of all his labor wherein he laboreth under the sun? 4 One generation goeth, and another generation cometh; but the [e]earth abideth for ever. 5 The [f]sun also ariseth, and the sun goeth down, and hasteth to its place where it [g]ariseth. 6 The [g]wind goeth toward the south, and turneth about unto the north; it turneth about continually in its course, and the wind returneth again to its circuits. 7 All the [2]rivers run into the sea, yet the sea is not full; unto the place whither the rivers go, thither they go again. 8 [3]All things are full of weariness; man cannot utter *it*: [h]the eye is not satisfied with seeing, nor the ear filled with hearing. 9 [i]That which hath been is that which shall be; and that which hath been done is that which shall be done: and there is no new thing under the sun. 10 Is there a thing whereof it may be said, See, this is new? it hath been long ago, in the ages which were before us. 11 There is [k]no remembrance of the former *generations*; neither shall there be any remembrance of the latter *generations* that are to come, among those that shall come after.

12 I the [l]Preacher was king over Israel in Jerusalem. 13 And I [m]applied my heart to seek and to [n]search out by wisdom concerning all that is done under heaven: it is a sore [o]travail that God hath given to the sons of men to be exercised therewith. 14 I have seen all the works that are done under the sun; and, behold, all is [p]vanity and [4]a striving after wind. 15 That which is [q]crooked cannot be made straight; and [5]that which is wanting cannot be numbered. 16 I communed with mine own heart, saying, Lo, I have gotten me great [r]wisdom [6]above all that were before me [7]in Jerusalem; yea, my heart [8]hath had great experience of wisdom and knowledge. 17 And I [s]applied my heart to know wisdom, and to [t]know madness and folly: I perceived that this also was a striving after wind. 18 For [u]in much wisdom is much grief; and he that increaseth knowledge increaseth sorrow.

2 I said in my heart, Come now, I will prove thee with [v]mirth; [9]therefore enjoy [10]pleasure: and, behold, this also was vanity. 2 [x]I said of laughter, It is mad; and of mirth, What doeth it? 3 I searched in my heart how to [y]cheer my flesh with wine, my heart yet [11]guiding *me* with wisdom, and how to lay hold on [z]folly, till I might see [a]what it was good for the sons of men that they should do under heaven [12]all the days of their life. 4 I made me great works; I [b]builded me houses; I planted me [c]vineyards; 5 I made me [d]gardens and [e]parks, and I planted trees in them of all kinds of fruit; 6 I made me [f]pools of water, to water therefrom the forest where trees were reared; 7 I bought men-servants and maid-servants,

[a] ver. 12; ch. 7. 27; 12. 8–10
[b] ver. 12
[c] ch. 12. 8; Ps. 39. 5, 6; 62. 9; 144. 4; Rom. 8. 20
[d] ch. 2. 11; 3. 9; 5. 16
[e] Ps. 104. 5; 119. 90
[f] Ps. 19. 4–6
[g] ch. 11. 5
[h] ch. 4. 8; Prov. 27. 20
[i] ch. 2. 12; 3. 15; 6. 10
[k] ch. 2. 16; 9. 5
[l] ver. 1
[m] ver. 17
[n] ch. 3. 10, 11; 7. 25; 8. 17
[o] ch. 2. 23, 26; 3. 10
[p] ch. 2. 11, 17; 4. 4; 6. 9
[q] ch. 7. 13
[r] ch. 2. 9; 1 K. 3. 12; 4. 30; 10. 23
[s] ver. 13
[t] ch. 2. 12; 7. 25
[u] ch. 2. 23; 12. 12
[v] ch. 7. 4; 8. 15
[x] ch. 7. 3, 6; Prov. 14. 13
[y] ch. 10. 19; Judg. 9. 13; Ps. 104. 15
[z] ch. 7. 25
[a] ver. 24; ch. 3. 12, 13; 5. 18; 6. 12; 8. 15; 12. 13
[b] 1 K. 7. 1–12
[c] S. S. 8. 11, 12
[d] S. S. 4. 16; 5. 1
[e] Neh. 2. 8
[f] Neh. 2. 14; 3. 15, 16

[1] Heb. *Koheleth.* [2] Or, *torrents* [3] Or, *All words are feeble* [4] Or, *a feeding on wind* (see Hos. 12. 1) Or, *vexation of spirit* (and so elsewhere) [5] Heb. *defect.* [6] Or, *yea, more than all* [7] Heb. *over.* [8] Heb. *hath seen abundantly.* [9] Or, *and thou shalt enjoy* [10] Or, *good* [11] Or, *holding its course* [12] Heb. *the number of days of their life.*

The Vanity of Possessions, of Wisdom, and of Labor. All Things have their Time, and are good in their Season

and had servants [a] born in my house; also I had great possessions of [b] herds and flocks, above all that were before me in Jerusalem; 8 I gathered me also silver and [c] gold, and the treasure of [d] kings and of the [e] provinces; I gat me [f] men-singers and women-singers, and the delights of the sons of men, [1] musical instruments, and that of all sorts. 9 So I was [g] great, and increased more than all that were before me in Jerusalem: also my wisdom [2] remained with me. 10 And [h] whatsoever mine eyes desired I kept not from them; I withheld not my heart from any joy; for my heart rejoiced because of all my labor; and this was my [i] portion from all my labor. 11 Then I looked on all the works that my hands had wrought, and on the labor that I had labored to do; and, behold, all was [k] vanity and a striving after wind, and there was [l] no profit under the sun.

12 And I turned myself to [m] behold wisdom, and madness, and folly: for what *can* the man *do* that cometh [3] after the king? *even* [n] that which hath been done long ago. 13 Then I saw that [o] wisdom excelleth folly, as far as light excelleth darkness. 14 The wise man's eyes are in his head, and the [p] fool walketh in darkness: and yet I perceived that [q] one event happeneth to them all. 15 Then said I in my heart, [r] As it happeneth to the fool, so will it happen even to me; and [s] why was I then more wise? Then said I in my heart, that this also is vanity. 16 For of the wise man, even as of the fool, there is [t] no remembrance for ever; seeing that in the days to come all will have been long forgotten. And [u] how doth the wise man die even as the fool! 17 So I [v] hated life, because the work that is wrought under the sun was grievous unto me; for all is [k] vanity and a striving after wind.

18 And I hated [z] all my labor wherein I labored under the sun, seeing that I must [y] leave it unto the man that shall be after me. 19 And who knoweth whether he will be a wise man or a fool? yet will he have rule over all my labor wherein I have labored, and wherein I have showed myself wise under the sun. This also is vanity. 20 Therefore I turned about to cause my heart to despair concerning [z] all the labor wherein I had labored under the sun. 21 For there is a man whose labor is with wisdom, and with knowledge, and with [4] [z] skilfulness; yet to a man that hath not labored therein shall he [5] [a] leave it for his portion. This also is vanity and a great evil. 22 For what hath a man of [z] all his labor, and of the [6] [b] striving of his heart, wherein he laboreth under the sun? 23 For all his days are *but* [c] sorrows, and his travail is grief; yea, even in the night his heart [d] taketh no rest. This also is vanity.

24 There is [e] nothing better for a man *than* that he should eat and drink, and make his soul enjoy good in his labor. This also I saw, that it is [f] from the hand of God. 25 For who can eat, or who can [7] have enjoyment, [8] more than I? 26 For to the man that pleaseth him [g] *God* giveth wisdom, and knowledge, and joy; but [h] to the sinner he giveth travail, to gather and to heap up, that he may [i] give to him that pleaseth God. This also is [k] vanity and a striving after wind.

3 For everything there is a season, and a [l] time for every [9] purpose under heaven: 2 a time to be born, and a [m] time to die; a time to plant, and a time to pluck up that which is planted; 3 a time to kill, and a time to heal; a time to break down, and a time to build up; 4 a time to [n] weep, and a time to [o] laugh; a time to mourn, and a time to [p] dance; 5 a time to cast away stones, and a time to gather stones together; a time to embrace, and a time to refrain from embracing; 6 a time to seek, and a time to lose; a time to keep, and a time to cast away; 7 a time to rend, and a time to sew; a time to [q] keep silence, and a time to speak; 8 a time to love, and a time to [r] hate; a time for war, and a time for

[a] Gen. 14. 14; 15. 3
[b] 1 K. 4. 23
[c] 1 K. 9. 28; 10. 10, 14, 21
[d] 1 K. 4. 21
[e] 1 K. 20. 14; Lam. 1. 1
[f] 2 S. 19. 35
[g] ch. 1. 16; 1 Chr. 29. 25
[h] ch. 6. 2
[i] ch. 3. 22; 5. 18; 9. 9
[k] ver. 22, 23; ch. 1. 14
[l] ch. 1. 3; 3. 9; 5. 16
[m] ch. 1. 17
[n] c. 1. 9, 10
[o] ch. 7. 11, 12, 19; 9. 18; 10. 10
[p] Prov. 17. 24; 1 Jn. 2. 11
[q] ch. 3. 19; 6. 6; 7. 2; 9. 2, 3; Ps. 49. 10
[r] ver. 16
[s] ch. 6. 8, 11
[t] ch. 1. 11; 4. 16; 9. 5
[u] ver. 14
[v] ch. 4. 2
[z] ver. 11; ch. 1. 3
[y] Ps. 39. 6; 49. 10

[z] ch. 4. 4
[a] ver. 18
[b] ch. 1. 14
[c] ch. 1. 18; 5. 17; Job 5. 7; 14. 1
[d] Ps. 127. 2
[e] ver. 3; ch. 3. 12, 13, 22; 5. 18; 6. 12; 8. 15; 9. 7; 1 Tim. 6. 17
[f] ch. 3. 13
[g] Job 32. 8; Prov. 2. 6
[h] Job 15. 20
[i] Job 27. 16, 17; Prov. 13. 22
[k] ch. 1. 14
[l] ver. 17; ch. 8. 6
[m] Job 14. 5; Heb. 9. 27

[n] Rom. 12. 15
[o] Ps. 126. 2

[p] Ex. 15. 20

[q] Am. 5. 13

[r] Ps. 101. 3; Prov. 13. 5

[1] Or, *concubines very many* The meaning of the Hebrew is very uncertain. [2] Or, *stood by me*
[3] Or, *after the king, even him whom they made king long ago?* Or, *after the king, in those things which have been already done?*

[4] Or, *success* [5] Heb. *give.*
[6] Or, *vexation* [7] Or, *hasten* thereto
[8] Acc. to Sept. and Syr., *apart from him.*
[9] Or, *matter*

peace. 9 [a]What profit hath he that worketh in that wherein he laboreth? 10 I have seen the [b]travail which God hath given to the sons of men to be exercised therewith. 11 He hath [c]made everything beautiful in its time: also he hath set [1]eternity in their heart, yet so that man [d]cannot find out the work that God hath done from the beginning even to the end. 12 I know that there is [e]nothing better for them, than to rejoice, and [2]to do good so long as they live. 13 And also that every man should eat and drink, and enjoy good in all his labor, is the [f]gift of God. 14 I know that, whatsoever God doeth, it shall be for ever: nothing can be put to it, nor anything taken from it; and God hath done it, that men should [g]fear before him. 15 [3]That [h]which is hath been long ago; and that which is to be hath long ago been: and God seeketh again that which is [4]passed away.

16 And moreover I saw under the sun, in the place of justice, that [i]wickedness was there; and in the place of righteousness, that wickedness was there. 17 I said in my heart, [k]God will judge the righteous and the wicked; for there is a [l]time there for every [5]purpose and for every work. 18 [6]I said in my heart, *It is* because of the sons of men, that God may prove them, and that they may see that they themselves are *but as* [m]beasts. 19 [n]For that which befalleth the sons of men befalleth beasts; even one thing befalleth them: as the one dieth, so dieth the other; yea, they have all one [7]breath; and man hath no preëminence above the beasts: for all is vanity. 20 All go unto one place; all are of the [o]dust, and all turn to dust again. 21 Who knoweth the [p]spirit [8]of man, [9]whether it goeth upward, and the spirit of the beast, [9]whether it goeth downward to the earth? 22 Wherefore I saw that there is [q]nothing better, than that a man should rejoice in his works; for that is his portion: for who shall bring him *back* to see [r]what shall be after him?

1 Or, *the world* 2 Or, *to get good*
3 Or, *That which hath been is now*
4 Heb. *driven away* 5 Or, *matter*
6 Or, *I said in my heart concerning the sons of men.* It is *that God &c.* 7 Or, *spirit*
8 Heb. *of the sons of men.* 9 Or, *that goeth*

[a] ch. 1. 3; 2. 11; 5. 16
[b] ch. 1. 13; 2. 26
[c] Gen. 1. 31
[d] ch. 7. 23; 8. 17; Job 5. 9; Rom. 11. 33
[e] ch. 2. 24, ref.
[f] ch. 2. 24; 5. 19
[g] ch. 5. 7; 7. 18; 8. 12, 13; 12. 13
[h] ch. 1. 9; 6. 10
[i] ch. 4. 1; 5. 8; 8. 9
[k] ch. 11. 9; Gen. 18. 25; Ps. 96. 13; 98. 9; Mt. 16. 27; Rom. 2. 6–10; 2 Th. 1. 6–9
[l] ver. 1; ch. 8. 6
[m] Ps. 49. 12, 20; 73. 22
[n] ch. 9. 12
[o] ch. 12. 7; Gen. 3. 19; Ps. 103. 14
[p] ch. 12. 7
[q] ch. 2. 24
[r] ch. 2. 18; 6. 12; 8. 7; 10. 14

[s] ch. 3. 16; 5. 8; Job 35. 9; Ps. 12. 5; Is. 5. 7
[t] Lam. 1. 9
[u] ch. 2. 17; Job 3. 11–26
[v] ch. 6: 3
[x] ch. 2. 21
[y] ch. 1. 14
[z] Prov. 6. 10; 24. 33
[a] Is. 9. 20
[b] Prov. 15. 16, 17; 16. 8
[c] ch. 1. 8; 5. 10; Prov. 27. 20
[d] ch. 2. 21
[e] ch. 1. 13
[f] 1 K. 1. 1

[g] ch. 7. 19; 9. 15

[h] Gen. 41. 14, 41–43

4 Then I returned and saw all the [s]oppressions that are done under the sun: and, behold, the tears of such as were oppressed, and they had [t]no comforter; and on the side of their oppressors there was power; but they had no comforter. 2 Wherefore [u]I praised the dead that have been long dead more than the living that are yet alive; 3 yea, [10v]better than them both *did I esteem* him that hath not yet been, who hath not seen the evil work that is done under the sun.

4 Then I saw all labor and every [11x]skilful work, that [12]for this a man is envied of his neighbor. This also is [y]vanity and a striving after wind. 5 The fool [z]foldeth his hands together, and [a]eateth his own flesh. 6 [b]Better is a handful, [13]with quietness, than two handfuls [13]with labor and striving after wind.

7 Then I returned and saw vanity under the sun. 8 There is one that is alone, and he hath not a second; yea, he hath neither son nor brother; yet is there no end of all his labor, neither are [c]his eyes satisfied with riches. [d]For whom then, *saith he*, do I labor, and deprive my soul of good? This also is vanity, yea, it is a [e]sore travail. 9 Two are better than one, because they have a good reward for their labor. 10 For if they fall, the one will lift up his fellow; but woe to him that is alone when he falleth, and hath not another to lift him up. 11 Again, if two lie together, then they have warmth; but [f]how can one be warm *alone*? 12 And if a man prevail against him that is alone, two shall withstand him; and a threefold cord is not quickly broken.

13 Better is a [g]poor and wise youth than an old and foolish king, who knoweth not how to receive admonition any more. 14 For [h]out of prison he came forth to be king; yea, even in his kingdom he was born poor. 15 I saw all the living that walk under the sun, that they were with the youth, the second, that stood up in his stead. 16 [14]There was no end of all the

10 Or, *better than they both is he that &c.*
11 Or, *successful*
12 Or, *it cometh of a man's rivalry with his neighbor* 13 Or, *of*
14 Or, *There is no end, in the mind of all the people, to all that hath been before them; they also &c.*

Piety enjoined. False and True Use of Riches. Vanity of Good Things which cannot be enjoyed

people, even of all them over whom he was: yet they that come after shall not rejoice in him. Surely this also is [a] vanity and a striving after wind.

*5 [b] Keep thy foot when thou goest to the house of God; for to draw nigh to hear is better than to give the [c] sacrifice of fools: for they know not that they do evil. *2 Be not [d] rash with thy mouth, and let not thy heart be hasty to utter [1] anything before God; for God is in heaven, and thou upon earth: therefore let thy [e] words be few. 3 For a dream cometh with a multitude of [2] business, and a [f] fool's voice with a multitude of words. 4 When thou [g] vowest a vow unto God, defer not to pay it; for he hath no pleasure in fools: [h] pay that which thou vowest. 5 [i] Better is it that thou shouldest not vow, than that thou shouldest vow and not pay. 6 Suffer not thy mouth to cause thy flesh to sin; neither say thou before the [3] angel, that it was an [k] error: wherefore should God be angry at thy voice, and destroy the work of thy hands? 7 For in the multitude of dreams there are vanities, and in many words: but [l] fear thou God.

8 If thou seest the [m] oppression of the poor, and the [n] violent taking away of justice and righteousness in [4] a province, [o] marvel not at the matter: for [p] one higher than the high regardeth; and there are higher than they. 9 [5] Moreover the profit of the earth is for all: the king *himself* is served by the field.

10 [q] He that loveth silver shall not be satisfied with silver; nor he that loveth abundance, with increase: this also is vanity. 11 [r] When goods increase, they are increased that eat them; and what advantage is there to the owner thereof, save the beholding *of them* with his eyes? 12 The sleep of a laboring man is [s] sweet, whether he eat little or much; but the fulness of the rich will not suffer him to sleep.

13 There is a grievous evil which I have seen under the sun, *namely*, [t] riches kept by the owner thereof to his hurt: 14 and those riches perish by evil [2] adventure; and if he hath begotten a son, there is nothing in his hand. 15 [u] As he came forth from his mother's womb, naked shall he go again as he came, and shall take [v] nothing for his labor, which he may carry away in his hand. 16 And this also is a grievous evil, that in all points as he came, so shall he go: and [x] what profit hath he that he [y] laboreth for the wind? 17 All his days also he eateth in darkness, and he is [z] sore vexed, and hath sickness and wrath.

18 Behold, [6] that which I have seen to be [a] good and to be comely is for one to eat and to drink, and to enjoy good in all his labor, wherein he laboreth under the sun, [7] all the days of his life which God hath given him: for this is his [b] portion. 19 Every man also to whom [c] God hath given riches and wealth, and hath given him [d] power to eat thereof, and to take his portion, and to rejoice in his labor—this is the [e] gift of God. 20 For he shall not much remember the days of his life; because God answereth *him* in the joy of his heart.

6 There is an [f] evil which I have seen under the sun, and it is heavy upon men: 2 a man to whom God [g] giveth riches, wealth, and honor, so that he [h] lacketh nothing for his soul of all that he desireth, yet God giveth him not power to eat thereof, but an alien eateth it: this is vanity, and it is an evil disease. 3 If a man beget a hundred children, and live many years, so that the days of his years are many, but his soul be not filled with good, and moreover he have [i] no burial; I say, that [k] an untimely birth is better than he: 4 for it cometh in vanity, and departeth in darkness, and the name thereof is covered with darkness; 5 moreover it hath not seen the sun [8] nor known it: [9] this hath rest rather than the other: 6 yea, though he live a thousand years twice told, and yet enjoy no good, [l] do not all go to one place?

7 [m] All the labor of man is for his mouth, and yet the appetite is not filled. 8 For [n] what advantage hath

[a] ch. 1. 14

*[Ch. 4. 17 in Heb.]

[b] Ex. 3. 5; 30. 18–20; Is. 1. 12

*[Ch. 5. 1 in Heb.]

[c] 1 S. 15. 22; Prov. 15. 8; 21. 27

[d] Prov. 20. 25

[e] Prov. 10. 19; Mt 6. 7

[f] ch. 10. 14; Job 11. 2

[g] Num. 30. 2; Ps. 50. 14; 76. 11

[h] Ps. 66. 13, 14

[i] Prov. 20. 25; Acts 5. 4

[k] Lev. 4. 2, 22; Num. 15. 25, &c.

[l] ch. 3. 14; 7. 18; 8. 12, 13; 12. 13

[m] ch. 4. 1

[n] Ezek. 18. 18

[o] 1 Pet. 4. 12

[p] Ex. 2. 25; Ps. 12. 5

[q] ch. 2. 10, 11

[r] ch. 2. 9

[s] Prov. 3. 24

[t] ch. 6. 2

[u] Job 1. 21

[v] Ps. 49. 17; 1 Tim. 6. 7

[x] ch. 1. 3; 2. 11; 3. 9

[y] Prov. 11. 29

[z] ch. 2. 23

[a] ch. 2. 24, ref.

[b] ch. 2. 10

[c] ch. 6. 2; 2 Chr. 1. 12

[d] ch. 6. 2

[e] ch. 3. 13

[f] ch. 5. 13

[g] 1 K. 3. 13

[h] Ps. 17. 14; 73. 7

[i] Is. 14. 20; Jer. 8. 2; 22. 19

[k] ch. 4. 3; Job 3. 16

[l] ch. 2. 14, ref.

[m] Prov. 16. 26

[n] ch. 2. 15

[1] Or, *a word* [2] Or, *travail*
[3] Or, *messenger* of God See Mal. 2. 7.
[4] Or, *the state*
[5] Or, *But the profit of a land every way is a king that maketh himself servant to the field* (or, *is a king over the cultivated field*)
[6] Or, *that which I have seen: it is good and comely for one &c.*
[7] Heb. *the number of the days.*
[8] Or, *neither had any knowledge*
[9] Or, *it is better with this than with the other*

the wise more than the fool? [1]*or* what hath the poor man, that knoweth how to walk before the living? 9 Better is the [a] sight of the eyes than the wandering of the desire: this also is [b] vanity and a striving after wind.

10 [2] Whatsoever [c] hath been, the name thereof was given long ago; and it is known what [3] man is; [d] neither can he contend with him that is mightier than he. 11 Seeing there are many [4] things that increase vanity, what is man the better? 12 For who knoweth what is good for man in *his* life, [5] all the days of his vain life which he spendeth as a shadow? for who can tell a man [e] what shall be after him under the sun?

7 A [f] *good* name is better than precious oil; and the [g] day of death, than the day of one's birth. 2 It is better to go to the house of mourning than to go to the house of feasting: for that is the [h] end of all men; and the living will [i] lay it to his heart. 3 [k] Sorrow is better than laughter; for [l] by the sadness of the countenance the heart is made [6] glad. 4 The heart of the wise is in the house of mourning; but the heart of fools is in the house of mirth.

5 It is better to [m] hear the rebuke of the wise, than for a man to hear the song of fools. 6 For as the crackling of [n] thorns under a pot, so is the [o] laughter of the fool: this also is vanity. 7 [7] Surely [p] extortion maketh the wise man foolish; and a [q] bribe destroyeth the understanding.

8 Better is the [r] end of a thing than the beginning thereof; *and* the [s] patient in spirit is better than the proud in spirit. 9 Be not [t] hasty in thy spirit to be [8] angry; for [9] anger resteth in the bosom of fools. 10 Say not thou, What is the cause that the former days were better than these? for thou dost not inquire [10] wisely concerning this.

11 Wisdom [11] is as good as an inheritance; yea, [u] more excellent is it for them that see the sun. 12 For [v] wisdom is a defence, even as money is a defence; but the excellency of knowledge is, that [x] wisdom preserveth the life of him that hath it. 13 Consider the [y] work of God: for who [z] can make that straight, which he hath made crooked? 14 [a] In the day of prosperity be joyful, and [b] in the day of adversity consider; yea, God hath made the one side by side with the other, to the end that man should [c] not find out anything *that shall be* after him.

15 All this have I seen in my [d] days of vanity: there is a [e] righteous man that perisheth in his righteousness, and there is [f] a wicked man that prolongeth *his life* in his evil-doing. 16 Be not righteous overmuch; neither [g] make thyself overwise: why shouldest thou destroy thyself? 17 Be not overmuch wicked, neither be thou foolish: why shouldest thou [h] die before thy time? 18 It is good that thou shouldest take hold of [i] this; yea, also from [k] that withdraw not thy hand: for he that [l] feareth God shall come forth from them all.

19 [m] Wisdom is a strength to the wise man more than ten rulers that are in a city. 20 [7] Surely [n] there is not a righteous man upon earth, that doeth good, and sinneth not. 21 Also [12] take not heed unto all words that are spoken, lest thou hear thy servant [o] curse thee; 22 for oftentimes also thine own heart knoweth that thou thyself likewise hast cursed others.

23 All this have I [13] proved in wisdom: I said, I will be wise; [p] but it was far from me. 24 That which [14] is, is far off and [q] exceeding deep; [r] who can find it out? 25 I turned about, and my heart *was set* to know and to search out, and to seek wisdom and the reason *o things*, and to know [15] that wickedness is folly, and that [s] foolishness is madness. 26 And I find more [t] bitter than death the woman [16] whose heart is [u] snares and nets *and* whose hands are bands: [v] whoso pleaseth God shall escape from her; but [x] the sinner shall be taken by her. 27 Behold, this have I found, saith the Preacher, [17] *laying* one

[a] ch. 11. 9
[b] ch. 1. 14
[c] ch. 1. 9; 3. 15
[d] Prov. 21. 30; Job 9. 32; 40. 2; Is. 45. 9
[e] ch. 3. 22, ref.
[f] Prov. 22. 1
[g] ver. 8; ch. 4. 2
[h] ch. 2. 16; 3. 19, 20; 6. 6; 9. 2, 3
[i] Ps. 90. 12
[k] ch. 2. 2
[l] 2 Cor. 7. 10
[m] ch. 9. 17; Ps. 141. 5; Prov. 6. 23; 13. 18; 15. 31, 32; 25. 12
[n] Ps. 58. 9; 118. 12
[o] ch. 2. 2
[p] ch. 4. 1; 5. 8
[q] Ex. 23. 8; Dt. 16. 19; Prov. 17. 8, 23
[r] ver. 1
[s] Prov. 14. 29; 16. 32; Gal. 5. 22; Eph. 4. 2
[t] Prov. 14. 17; Jas. 1. 19
[u] Prov. 8. 10, 11

[v] ver. 19; ch. 9. 18
[x] Prov. 3. 18; 8. 35
[y] ch. 3. 11; 8. 17
[z] ch. 1. 15
[a] ch. 3. 22; 9. 7; 11. 9; Dt. 26. 11
[b] Dt. 8. 5
[c] ch. 3. 22, ref.
[d] ch. 6. 12; 9. 9
[e] ch. 8. 14
[f] ch. 8. 12, 13
[g] Rom. 12. 3
[h] Job 22. 16; Ps. 55. 23; Prov. 10. 27
[i] ver. 16
[k] ver. 17
[l] ch. 3. 14; 5. 7; 8. 12, 13; 12. 13
[m] ver. 12; ch. 9. 13-18
[n] 1 K. 8. 46; 2 Chr. 6. 36; Ps. 143. 2; Prov. 20. 9; Rom. 3. 23
[o] Prov. 30. 11
[p] ch. 3. 11; 8. 17
[q] Rom. 11. 33
[r] Job 11. 7; 37. 23
[s] ch. 1. 17; 10. 13
[t] Prov. 5. 4
[u] Prov. 7. 23
[v] Prov. 6. 23, 24
[x] Prov. 22. 14

[1] Or, or *the poor man that hath understanding, in walking before the living*
[2] Or, *Whatsoever he be, his name was given him long ago, and it is known that he is man*
[3] Heb. *Adam.* See Gen. 2. 7.
[4] Or, *words*
[5] Heb. *the number of the days.*
[6] Or, *better*
[7] Or, *For*
[8] Or, *vexed*
[9] Or, *vexation*
[10] Heb. *out of wisdom*
[11] Or, *is good together with an inheritance, and profitable unto them &c.*
[12] Heb. *give not thy heart.*
[13] Or, *tried by*
[14] Or, *hath been*
[15] Or, *the wickedness of folly, and foolishness* which is *madness*
[16] Or, *who is a snare, and her heart is* as *nets*
[17] Or, weighing *one thing after another, to find out the reason*

thing to another, to find out the account; 28 which my soul still seeketh, but I have not found: one man among a thousand have I found; but a [a]woman among all those have I not found. 29 Behold, this only have I found: that [b]God made man upright; but they have sought out many inventions.

8 Who is as the wise man? and who knoweth the interpretation of a thing? A man's wisdom maketh his [c]face to shine, and the [1][d]hardness of his face is changed. 2 I *counsel thee*, Keep the king's command, and that in regard of the [e]oath of God. 3 Be not hasty to [f]go out of his presence; persist not in an evil thing: for he doeth whatsoever pleaseth him. 4 For the king's word *hath* power; and [g]who may say unto him, What doest thou? 5 Whoso [h]keepeth the commandment [i]shall know no evil thing; and a wise man's heart discerneth time and judgment: 6 for [k]to every [2]purpose there is a time and judgment; because the [3]misery of man is great upon him: 7 for he [l]knoweth not that which shall be; [4]for who can tell him how it shall be? 8 [m]There is no man that hath power over the [5]spirit to retain the [5]spirit; neither hath he power over the day of death; and there is no [n]discharge [6]in war: [o]neither shall wickedness deliver him that is given to it.

9 All this have I seen, and applied my heart unto every work that is done under the sun: [7]*there is* a time wherein one man hath [p]power over another [8]to his hurt. 10 So I saw the wicked buried, [9]and they came *to the grave*; and they that had done right went away from the holy place, and [q]were forgotten in the city: this also is vanity. 11 Because [r]sentence against an evil work is not executed speedily, therefore [s]the heart of the sons of men is [10]fully set in them to do evil. 12 Though a sinner do evil a hundred times, and [t]prolong his *days*, yet surely I know that it shall be [u]well with them that fear God, that fear before him: 13 but it shall [v]not be well with the wicked, neither shall he prolong *his* days, *which are* as a [x]shadow; because he feareth not before God.

14 There is a vanity which is done upon the earth, that there are [y]righteous men unto whom it happeneth according to the work of the wicked; again, there are [z]wicked men to whom it happeneth according to the work of the righteous: I said that this also is vanity. 15 Then I commended mirth, because [a]a man hath no better thing under the sun, than to eat, and to drink, and to be joyful: [11]for that shall abide with him in his labor *all* the days of his life which God hath given him under the sun.

16 When I [b]applied my heart to know wisdom, and to see the [12]business that is done upon the earth ([13]for also there is that [c]neither day nor night seeth sleep with his eyes), 17 then I beheld all the work of God, that [d]man cannot find out the work that is done under the sun: because however much a man labor to seek it out, yet he shall not find it; yea moreover, [e]though a wise man think to know it, yet shall he not be able to find it. 9 1 For all this I laid to my heart, even to explore all this: that the righteous, and the wise, and their works, are [f]in the hand of God; whether it be [g]love or hatred, [h]man knoweth it not; all is before them.

2 [i]All things come alike to all: there is [k]one event to the righteous and to the wicked; to the good and to the clean and to the unclean; to him that sacrificeth and to him that sacrificeth not; as is the good, so is the sinner; *and* he that sweareth, as he that feareth an oath. 3 This is an evil in all that is done under the sun, that there is [l]one event unto all: yea also, [m]the heart of the sons of men is full of evil, and [n]madness is in their heart while they live, and after that *they go* to the dead. 4 [14]For to him that is joined with all the living there is hope; for a liv-

[a] 1 K. 11. 3
[b] Gen. 1. 27
[c] Ex. 34. 29, 30
[d] Dt. 28. 50
[e] Ex. 22. 11; 2 S. 21. 7; Ezek. 17. 18
[f] ch. 10. 4
[g] Job 9. 12; Dan. 4. 35
[h] ch. 12. 13
[i] Prov. 12. 21
[k] ch. 3. 1, 17
[l] ch. 3. 22; 6. 12; 7. 14; 9. 12
[m] Ps. 49. 7–9
[n] Dt. 20. 5–8
[o] ver. 13
[p] ch. 4. 1; 5. 8; 7. 7
[q] ch. 1. 11; 2. 16; 4. 16; 9. 5, 15
[r] Ex. 34. 6; Ps. 86. 15; Rom. 2. 4; 2 Pet. 3. 9
[s] ch. 9. 3
[t] ch. 7. 15; Is. 65. 20
[u] Dt. 4. 40; 12. 25; Ps. 37. 11; Prov. 1. 33; Is. 3. 10

[v] ver. 8; Is. 3. 11
[x] ch. 6. 12; Job 14. 2
[y] ch. 7. 15; Ps. 73. 14
[z] Job 21. 7; Ps. 73. 3, 12; Jer. 12. 1; Mal. 3. 15
[a] ch. 2. 24; 3. 12, 13; 5. 18; 9. 7
[b] ch. 1. 13, 14
[c] ch. 2. 23
[d] ch. 3. 11
[e] ch. 7. 23; Ps. 73. 16; Rom. 11. 33
[f] Dt. 33. 3; Job 12. 10; Ps. 119. 109
[g] ver. 6
[h] ch. 10. 14
[i] ver. 11; Job 9. 22
[k] ch. 2. 14; 3. 19; 6. 6; 7. 2
[l] ver. 2
[m] ch. 8. 11
[n] ch. 1. 17

1 Heb. *strength.* 2 Or, *matter* 3 Or, *evil*
4 Or, *for* even *when it cometh to pass, who shall declare it unto him?* 5 Or, *wind* 6 Or, *in battle*
7 Or, *what time one man had &c.*
8 Or, *to his own hurt*
9 Or, *who had come and gone away from the holy place; and they were forgotten in the city where they had so done* Or, *and men came and went &c.* 10 Or, *emboldened*

[n] Or, *and that this should accompany him*
12 Or, *travail*
13 Or, *how that neither by day nor by night do men see sleep with their eyes*
14 Another reading is, *For who is exempted? With all &c.*, or *who can choose? With all &c.*

ing dog is better than a dead lion. 5 For the living know that they shall die: but the dead [a] know not anything, neither have they any more a reward; for the [b] memory of them is forgotten. 6 As well their love, as their hatred and their envy, is perished long ago; neither have they any more a [c] portion for ever in anything that is done under the sun.

7 Go thy way, [d] eat thy bread with joy, and drink thy wine with a merry heart; for God hath already accepted thy works. 8 Let thy [e] garments be always white; and let not thy [f] head lack oil. 9 [1] Live joyfully with the wife whom thou lovest all the days of thy [g] life of vanity, which he hath given thee under the sun, all thy days of vanity: for that is thy [c] portion in life, and in thy labor wherein thou laborest under the sun. 10 Whatsoever thy hand [2] findeth to do, [h] do *it* with thy might; for there is [i] no work, nor device, nor knowledge, nor wisdom, in [k] Sheol, whither thou goest.

11 I returned, and saw under the sun, that the [l] race is not to the swift, nor the [m] battle to the strong, neither yet bread to the wise, nor yet [n] riches to men of understanding, nor yet favor to men of skill; but time and [o] chance happeneth to them all. 12 For man also [p] knoweth not his time: as the fishes that are taken in an evil net, and as the [q] birds that are caught in the snare, even so are the sons of men [r] snared in an evil time, when it falleth [s] suddenly upon them.

13 I have also seen wisdom under the sun on this wise, and it seemed great unto me: 14 There was a little city, and few men within it; and there came a great king against it, and besieged it, and built great bulwarks against it. 15 Now there was found in it a [t] poor wise man, and he [u] by his wisdom delivered the city; yet [v] no man remembered that same poor man. 16 Then said I, [x] Wisdom is better than strength: nevertheless the poor man's wisdom is despised, and his words are not heard. 17 The [y] words of the wise heard in quiet are better than the cry of him that ruleth among fools. 18 [z] Wisdom is better than weapons of war; but [a] one sinner destroyeth much good.

10 Dead flies cause the oil of the [b] perfumer [c] to send forth an evil odor; *so* doth a little folly [4] outweigh wisdom and honor. 2 A wise man's heart is at his right hand; but a fool's heart at his left. 3 Yea also, when the fool walketh by the way, his [5] understanding faileth him, and [c] he saith [6] to every one *that* he is a fool. 4 If the spirit of the ruler rise up against thee, [d] leave not thy place; for [7] [e] gentleness allayeth great offences.

5 There is an evil which I have seen under the sun, as it were an [f] error which proceedeth from the ruler: 6 [g] folly is set in great [8] dignity, and the rich sit in a low place. 7 I have seen [h] servants [i] upon horses, and princes walking like servants upon the earth.

8 [k] He that diggeth a pit shall fall into it; and whoso breaketh through a wall, a [l] serpent shall bite him. 9 Whoso [9] heweth out stones shall be hurt therewith; *and* he that cleaveth wood is endangered thereby. 10 If the iron be blunt, and one do not whet the edge, then must he put to more strength: but wisdom is profitable to direct. 11 [10] If the serpent bite [11] [m] before it is charmed, then is there no advantage in [12] the charmer.

12 The [n] words of a wise man's mouth are gracious; but the lips of a [o] fool will swallow up himself. 13 The beginning of the words of his mouth is foolishness; and the end of [13] his talk is mischievous [p] madness. 14 [q] A fool also multiplieth words: *yet* man knoweth not what shall be; and [r] that which shall be after him, who can tell him? 15 The labor of fools wearieth every one of them; for he knoweth not how to go to the city.

16 Woe to thee, O land, when thy [s] king is a [14] child, and thy princes eat in the morning! 17 Happy art thou, O land, when thy

[a] Job 14. 21
[b] ch. 1. 11; 2. 16; 8. 10; Ps. 88. 12; Is. 26. 14
[c] ch. 2. 10; 3. 22
[d] ch. 2. 24, ref.
[e] Rev. 3. 4
[f] Ps. 23. 5
[g] ch. 6. 12; 7. 15
[h] ch. 11. 6; Rom. 12. 11; Col. 3. 23
[i] ver. 5
[k] Gen. 37. 35; Job 21. 13; Is. 38. 10
[l] Am. 2. 14, 15
[m] 2 Chr. 20. 15; Ps. 76. 5; Is. 40. 29; Zech. 4. 6
[n] Dt. 8. 17, 18
[o] 1 S. 6. 9
[p] ch. 8. 7
[q] Prov. 7. 23
[r] Prov. 29. 6; Is. 24. 18; Hos. 9. 8
[s] Lk. 21. 34, 35
[t] ch. 4. 13
[u] 2 S. 20. 22
[v] ch. 2. 16; 8. 10
[x] ch. 7. 12, 19
[y] ch. 7. 5; 10. 12
[z] ver. 16

[a] Josh. 7. 1-26; 2 K. 21. 2-17
[b] Ex. 30. 25
[c] Prov. 13. 16; 18. 2
[d] ch. 8. 3
[e] 1 S. 25. 24-33; Prov. 25. 15
[f] ch. 5. 6
[g] Esth. 3. 1; Prov. 28. 12; 29. 2
[h] Prov. 19. 10
[i] Esth. 6. 8
[k] Ps. 7. 15; Prov. 26. 27
[l] Am. 5. 19
[m] Ps. 58. 4, 5; Jer. 8. 17
[n] Prov. 10. 32; 22. 11; Lk. 4. 22
[o] ch. 4. 5; Prov. 10. 14; 18. 7
[p] ch. 7. 25
[q] ch. 5. 3; Prov. 15. 2
[r] ch. 3. 22; 6. 12; 7. 14; 8. 7
[s] Is. 3. 4, 12

1 Or, *Enjoy* (Heb *See*) *life*
2 Or, *attaineth to do by thy strength*, that *do*

3 Or, *to stink and putrefy*
4 Or, *him that is valued for wisdom*
5 Heb. *heart.* 6 Or, *of*
7 Or, *calmness leaveth great sins undone*
8 Heb. *heights.* 9 Or, *moveth stones*
10 Or, *Surely the serpent will bite where there is no enchantment; and the slanderer is no better*
11 Heb. *without enchantment*
12 Heb. *the master of the tongue.*
13 Heb. *his mouth.* 14 Or, *servant*

Charity and Industry to be exercised in Hope. Exhortation to labor in Joy amid Uncertainties, and to remember God in Youth

king is [1] the son of nobles, and thy princes eat in due season, for strength, and not for [a] drunkenness! 18 By [b] slothfulness the [2] roof sinketh in; and through idleness of the hands the house leaketh. 19 A feast is made for laughter, and [c] wine maketh glad the life; and [d] money answereth all things. 20 [e] Revile not the king, no, not in thy thought; and revile not the rich [f] in thy bedchamber: for a bird of the heavens shall carry the voice, and that which hath wings shall tell the matter.

11 [3] [g] Cast thy bread [4] upon the waters; for thou [h] shalt find it after many days. 2 [5] [i] Give a portion to seven, yea, even unto eight; for thou knowest not what [k] evil shall be upon the earth. 3 If the clouds be full of rain, they empty themselves upon the earth; and if a tree fall [6] toward the south, or [6] toward the north, in the place where the tree falleth, there shall it be. 4 He that observeth the wind shall not sow; and he that regardeth the clouds shall not reap. 5 As thou [l] knowest not what is the way of the [7] wind, *nor* [m] how the bones *do grow* in the womb of her that is with child; even so thou [n] knowest not the work of God who doeth all. 6 [o] In the morning sow thy seed, and in the evening withhold not thy hand; for thou knowest not which shall prosper, whether this or that, or whether they both shall be alike good. 7 Truly the light is sweet, and a pleasant thing it is for the eyes to [p] behold the sun. 8 [8] Yea, if a man live many years, let him [q] rejoice in them all; [9] but let him remember the [r] days of darkness, for they shall be many. All that cometh is vanity.

9 [s] Rejoice, O young man, in thy youth, and let thy heart cheer thee in the days of thy youth, and [t] walk in the ways of thy heart, and in the sight of thine eyes; but know thou, that for all these things [u] God will bring thee into judgment. 10 Therefore remove [10] sorrow from thy heart, and [v] put away evil from thy flesh; for youth and the dawn of life are

[1] Or, *a free man*
[2] Or, *rafters sink*
[3] Or, *Send forth*
[4] Heb. *upon the face of the waters.*
[5] Or, *Divide a portion into seven, yea, even into eight*
[6] Or, *in*
[7] Or, *spirit*
[8] Or, *For*
[9] Or, *and remember*
[10] Or, *vexation* Or, *provocation*

[a] Prov. 31. 4; Is. 5. 11
[b] Prov. 24. 30-34
[c] ch. 2. 3; Judg. 9. 13; Ps. 104. 15
[d] ch. 7. 12
[e] Ex. 22. 28; Acts 23. 5
[f] 2 K. 6. 12; Lk. 12. 3
[g] Is. 32. 20
[h] Dt. 15. 10; Prov. 19. 17; Mt. 10. 42; 2 Cor. 9. 8; Gal. 6. 9; Heb. 6. 10
[i] Ps. 112. 9; Mt. 5. 42; Lk. 6. 30; 1 Tim. 6. 18, 19
[k] ver. 8; ch. 12. 1
[l] Jn. 3. 8
[m] Ps. 139. 13-16
[n] ch. 1. 13; 3. 10, 11; 8. 17
[o] ch. 9. 10
[p] ch. 6. 5; 7. 11
[q] ch. 9. 7
[r] ch. 12. 1
[s] ch. 2. 10
[t] Num. 15. 39; Job 31. 7
[u] ch. 3. 17; 12. 14; Rom. 14. 10
[v] 2 Cor. 7. 1; 2 Tim. 2. 22

[w] Dt. 8. 18; Neh. 4. 14; Ps. 63. 6; 119. 55
[y] ch. 11. 8
[z] 2 S. 19. 35
[a] Is. 5. 30; 13. 10; Ezek. 32. 7, 8; Joel 3. 15; Mt. 24. 29
[b] Ps. 35. 14; 38. 6
[c] Gen. 27. 1; 48. 10; 1 S. 3. 2
[d] Ps. 141. 3
[e] Jer. 25. 10; Rev. 18. 22
[f] 2 S. 19. 35
[g] Job 17. 13; 30. 23
[h] Gen. 50. 10; Jer. 9. 17
[i] Zech. 4. 2, 3
[k] ch. 3. 20; Gen. 3. 19; Job 34. 15; Ps. 104. 29
[l] ch. 3. 21; Job 34. 14; Lk. 23. 46; Acts 7. 59
[m] Num. 16. 22; 27. 16; Is. 57. 16; Zech. 12. 1
[n] ch. 1. 2
[o] 1 K. 4. 32
[p] Prov. 10. 32
[q] Prov. 22. 20, 21
[r] ch. 7. 5; 10. 12; Prov. 1. 6; 22. 17
[s] Acts 2. 37

12 vanity. 1 [x] Remember also thy Creator in the days of thy youth, before the [y] evil days come, and the years draw nigh, when thou shalt say, [z] I have no pleasure in them; 2 before the [a] sun, and the light, and the moon, and the stars, are darkened, and the clouds return after the rain; 3 in the day when the keepers of the house shall tremble, and the strong men shall [b] bow themselves, and the [11] grinders cease because they are few, and [c] those that look out of the windows shall be darkened, 4 and the [d] doors shall be shut in the street; when the [e] sound of the grinding is low, and one shall rise up at the voice of a bird, and all the [f] daughters of music shall be brought low; 5 yea, they shall be afraid [12] of *that which is* high, and terrors *shall be* in the way; and the almond-tree shall blossom, and the grasshopper [13] shall be a burden, and [14] desire shall [15] fail; because man goeth to his everlasting [g] home, and the [h] mourners go about the streets: 6 before the silver cord is [16] loosed, or the [i] golden bowl is broken, or the pitcher is broken at the fountain, or the wheel broken at the cistern, 7 and the [k] dust returneth to the earth as it was, and the [l] spirit returneth unto [m] God who gave it. 8 [n] Vanity of vanities, saith the Preacher; all is vanity.

9 And further, because the Preacher was wise, he still taught the people knowledge; yea, he [17] pondered, and sought out, *and* set in order [o] many proverbs. 10 The Preacher sought to find out [18] [p] acceptable words, and that which was written uprightly, *even* [q] words of truth.

11 The [r] words of the wise are as [s] goads; and as [t] nails well fastened are *the words of* the [19] masters of assemblies, *which* are given from one shepherd. 12 [20] And furthermore, my son, be admonished: of making [u] many books there is no end; and [v] much study is a weariness of the flesh.

[t] Ezr. 9. 8; Is. 22. 23
[u] 1 K. 4. 32, 33
[v] ch. 1. 18

[11] Or, *grinding women*
[12] Or, of danger *from on high*
[13] Or, *shall drag itself along*
[14] Or, *the caperberry*
[15] Or, *burst*
[16] Or, *snapped asunder*
[17] Or, *gave ear*
[18] Heb. *words of delight.*
[19] Or, *collectors of sentences*
[20] Or, *And as for more than these, my son, be warned*

Concluding Observations

13 [1] *This is* the end of the matter; all hath been heard: [a] Fear God, and [b] keep his commandments; for [2] this is the [c] whole *duty* of man. 14 For [d] God will bring every work into judgment, [3] with every hidden thing, whether it be good, or whether it be evil.

[1] Or, *Let us hear the conclusion of the whole matter*
[2] Or, *this is* the duty of *all men*
[a] ch. 3. 14; 5. 7; 7. 18; 8. 12
[b] ch. 3. 5; Dt. 4. 2
[c] Dt. 10. 12; Mic. 6. 8
[d] ch. 3. 17; 11. 9; Mt. 10. 26; Rom. 2. 16; 1 Cor. 4. 5
[3] Or, *concerning*